

Multilinear Interpolation

June 15, 2026

In these notes I try to give an overview of some different approaches to multilinear interpolation. They are framed in the setting of [1, Chapter 2], which provides explanation for the notation and definitions used here and in [2]. This is the first time I have been in contact with these concepts, and all the errors are my responsibility!

Contents

1	Questions for Thiele	1
2	Introduction	2
2.1	Interpolating between two points	2
2.1.1	Complex method	3
2.1.2	Real method(s)	3
2.2	Interpolating on the interior of a convex set	4
3	Applications	4
3.1	Usage in the commuting ergodic averages paper	4

1 Questions for Thiele

- how/what kind of multilinear interpolation is used in the multiple ergodic averages
- how important are the bad tuples (quasi banach estimates) in practice? do we need them formalized?

- how important is it to have the optimal bounds on the weak parameters of the multilinear interpolation? does a weaker bound suffice if it means an easier proof?

2 Introduction

We introduce the problem by considering two cases.

2.1 Interpolating between two points

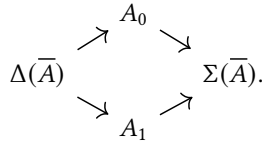
This is the case considered in [2]. It also seems to be used as a last step in the convex hull case, to be covered on section 2.2. A *Banach couple* is a pair $\overline{A} = (A_0, A_1)$ of Banach spaces that are subspaces of a common Hausdorff topological vector space. In this context, it makes sense to take the intersection $\Delta(\overline{A}) = A_0 \cap A_1$, which is a Banach space with the norm

$$\|a\|_{\Delta(\overline{A})} = \max\{\|a\|_{A_0}, \|a\|_{A_1}\},$$

and also their sum $\Sigma(\overline{A}) = A_0 \cup A_1$, which is also a Banach space when supplied with the norm

$$\|a\|_{\Sigma(\overline{A})} = \inf_{a=a_0+a_1} (\|a_0\|_{A_0} + \|a_1\|_{A_1}).$$

The picture looks like this:



For the rest of the section, we let

$$\overline{A}_1 = (A_0^{(1)}, A_1^{(1)}), \dots, \overline{A}_n = (A_0^{(n)}, A_1^{(n)})$$

and $\overline{B} = (B_0, B_1)$ be Banach couples.

2.1.1 Complex method

Our reference [2] writes that “it is well known that the real method of interpolation does not behave as well as the complex method for multi-linear operators”. The shortcoming of the complex method, however, is that it does not give us the Lebesgue space estimates that the real method is able to give. Let’s first revise how the multilinear result looks like for the complex method, so we can compare it with the real one.

Theorem 2.1 ([1, Theorem 4.4.1]). *Let*

$$T: \Delta(\overline{A}_1) \times \cdots \times \Delta(\overline{A}_n) \rightarrow \Delta(\overline{B}),$$

be a multilinear function, and assume

$$\|T(a_1, \dots, a_n)\|_{B_i} \leq K_i \|a_1\|_{A_i^{(1)}} \cdots \|a_n\|_{A_i^{(n)}}$$

for $a_j \in A_i^{(j)}$ and both $i = 0, 1$. Then for all $0 \leq \theta \leq 1$, T may be uniquely extended to a multilinear map

$$T: [\overline{A}_1]_\theta \times \cdots \times [\overline{A}_n]_\theta \rightarrow [\overline{B}]_\theta,$$

with norm at most $K_0^{1-\theta} K_1^\theta$.

This is enough for multilinear interpolation between L^p spaces:

Note 2.2 ([1, Section 5.1]). *If our Banach couple $\overline{A} = (A_0, A_1)$ is given by two L_p spaces $A_0 = L_{p_0}$ and $A_1 = L_{p_1}$ with $1 \leq p_0, p_1$, then for $0 \leq \theta \leq 1$ the complex interpolation space $[\overline{A}]_\theta$ is the Lebesgue space L_p where $p^{-1} = (1 - \theta)p_0^{-1} + \theta p_1^{-1}$.*

However, it does not give us Lebesgue space estimates! For that, we have to turn to the next tool.

2.1.2 Real method(s)

The main reason to consider the real method, then, will be the following:

Note 2.3 ([1, Theorem 5.3.1]). *If our Banach couple $\overline{A} = (A_0, A_1)$ is given by two Lebesgue spaces $A_0 = L_{p_0, q_0}$ and $A_1 = L_{p_1, q_1}$ where $p_0, p_1, q_0, q_1 \in (0, \infty]$, then for $0 < \theta < 1$ and $q \in (0, \infty]$, the real interpolation space $(\overline{A})_{\theta, q}$ is the Lebesgue space $L_{p, q}$ where $p^{-1} = (1 - \theta)p_0^{-1} + \theta p_1^{-1}$ when $p_0 \neq p_1$, and the same is true for $p_0 = p_1$ provided that $q^{-1} = (1 - \theta)q_0^{-1} + \theta q_1^{-1}$.*

$$T: \Sigma(\overline{A}_1) \times \cdots \times \Sigma(\overline{A}_n) \rightarrow \Sigma(\overline{B}),$$

be a multilinear function that restricts to two multilinear functions

$$T: A_i^{(1)} \times \cdots \times A_i^{(n)} \rightarrow B_i$$

for $i = 0, 1$, such that there are constants K_0, K_1 for which

$$\|T(f_1, \dots, f_n)\| \leq K_i \|f_1\| \cdots \|f_n\|$$

for $f_k \in A_i^{(k)}$ for $1 \leq k \leq n$, and each $i = 0, 1$.

Given $\theta \in (0, 1)$ and numbers $q_1, \dots, q_n, q \in [1, \infty]$ satisfying some specified conditions, we would be interested in showing that T also makes sense as a bounded multilinear operator between the intermediate subspaces given by the real interpolation method:

$$T: (\bar{A}_1)_{\theta, q_1} \times \cdots \times (\bar{A}_n)_{\theta, q_n} \rightarrow (\bar{B})_{\theta, q},$$

with some constant K depending on K_1 and K_2 .

2.2 Interpolating on the interior of a convex set

We assume that the Marcinkiewicz real interpolation theorem for linear operators is available, and we see how it can generalize to the multilinear case.

[3]

3 Applications

3.1 Usage in the commuting ergodic averages paper

References

- [1] Jöran Bergh and Jörgen Löfström. *Interpolation Spaces: An Introduction*. Repr. Die Grundlehren Der Mathematischen Wissenschaften in Einzeldarstellungen 223. Beijing: World Publ, 2003. 207 pp. ISBN: 978-3-540-07875-3 978-7-5062-6011-4 978-0-387-07875-5 (cit. on pp. 1, 3).
- [2] Svante Janson. “On Interpolation of Multi-Linear Operators”. In: *Function Spaces and Applications*. Ed. by Michael Cwikel et al. Red. by A. Dold and B. Eckmann. Vol. 1302. Berlin, Heidelberg: Springer Berlin Heidelberg, 1988, pp. 290–302. ISBN: 978-3-540-18905-3 978-3-540-38841-8. DOI: 10.1007/BFb0078880. URL: <http://link.springer.com/10.1007/BFb0078880> (visited on 06/11/2026) (cit. on pp. 1–3).

- [3] J. -L. Lions and J. Peetre. “Sur Une Classe D’Espaces D’Interpolation”. In: *Publications Mathématiques de l’Institut des Hautes Études Scientifiques* 19.1 (Dec. 1, 1964), pp. 5–68. issn: 1618-1913. doi: 10.1007/BF02684796. url: <https://doi.org/10.1007/BF02684796> (visited on 06/14/2026) (cit. on p. 4).